

Tantra That is a Condensed Summary of the Rite of Consecration

Supraṭiṣṭhātantrasaṃgraha · Toh 486 · Derge Kangyur

རབ་ཏུ་གྱུན་པ་མདོ་བསྟན་པའི་རྒྱ།

The Tantra That is a Condensed Summary of the Rite of Consecration, known in Sanskrit as the Supraṭiṣṭhātantrasaṃgraha and in Tibetan as Rab tu gnas pa mdor bsdus pa'i rgyud, is a tantric text concerned with the proper performance of consecration rites for sacred images, whether cast, painted, or sculpted in relief. It opens in the manner of a Buddha-word teaching, with the Blessed One entering a specific meditative absorption before expounding the requirements for both the officiant and the sacred object — covering the master's qualifications, the correct proportions and marks of images, and the associated mudrās, mantras, and ritual procedures. The text is presented in a mixture of prose and verse, giving it a character typical of condensed liturgical or ritual manuals within the tantric tradition. It is Toh 486 in the Kangyur, where it belongs among the tantric scriptures, and its homage to Vajrasattva situates it within the broader Vajrayāna ritual literature concerned with the empowerment and activation of devotional supports.

In the language of India: Supraṭiṣṭhātantrasaṃgraha. In the language of Tibet: The Tantra That is a Condensed Summary of the Rite of Consecration. Homage to the glorious Vajrasattva (Skt. Vajrasattva).

Thus did I hear. At one time, the Blessed One, the Tathāgata, having entered into the meditative absorption (samādhi) known as "The Vajra Blessing of the Samaya of All Tathāgatas," taught the rite of consecration for images that are cast, painted, or sculpted in relief, and so forth.

The master himself must know the ten,
and be fully endowed with every characteristic mark.
He must know the mudrā, the mantra, and the ritual,
and be skilled in all the rites.

The sacred image must bear the proper characteristic marks,
endowed with the flavor of peace and so forth.
Proportionate in measure, well-formed to the fitting standard —
one such as this is fit to be consecrated.

Moreover, in such places as stūpas and other sacred sites,
in dwelling-houses and in the abodes of gods,
the consecration of buddhas and so forth
must be performed together with the proper rites.
It must not be done with inferior rites,
for the consecration will always prove inauspicious,
bringing suffering in this present world
and great terror in the world beyond.
Therefore, with every effort,
let those who desire attainment practice with care and diligence.

The ritual, by the power of its own nature —
performed in the excellent manner taught in the tantras —
becomes a source of great merit for the one who performs it,
and results in rebirth among those who will see or be seen.
Through the characteristic marks of the sacred image and the mantra,
blessing will enter into it.

Wherever a sacred image is complete in form,
yet remains long without having been consecrated,
inauspiciousness will arise in relation to it,
and it is unfit to receive offerings for as long as that lasts.

As an analogy: when a person
has abandoned the defining marks of learning,
no one in the world will make offerings to him.
Just so it is with an image —
for a sacred image that has not been consecrated,
whoever makes offerings and prostrations to it,
it is like a homa of ashes without the proper samaya and mantra — fruitless,
equivalent to nothing.

Likewise, for one who dwells in the mantra and performs offering with proper
Dharma,
through the karmic maturation of that very act,
he will become an object of veneration in future births.

The bodhisattvas asked: "Blessed One, since all phenomena do not truly abide
anywhere, how then do the Victors perform consecration?"

The Blessed One declared:

All buddhas are perfectly present,
yet there is no fixed abiding anywhere.
They abide everywhere like space —
and it is through the other that consecration is performed.

Relying upon conventional truth of the world,
investigate the matter of consecration.
When examined in terms of ultimate truth,
who consecrates what, by whom, and where?

From the very beginning there is no arising —
what abides, how and in what manner?
This is done solely as a cause for the understanding
of sentient beings at the beginning of their path.

First, having thoroughly examined and purified the chosen site, one offers supreme supplication at canopies, victory banners, tall poles, and flags. The lama to whom supplication has been made, furnished with incense, flowers, and so forth, places the sacred object in the consecration site on an auspicious date and under auspicious stellar conditions, with the master settled in excellent meditative equipoise. It is to be associated with the five families of buddhas, bodhisattvas, and so forth. Having performed the maṇḍala rite connected with those five families — taking the ground, drawing the lines, performing the colored-sand work, making supplication, and so forth — one recites the root mantra or, in accordance with the intention of the tantra, places a jewel or a ring in the earth-treasury. Then one first admits one's own disciple into the shrine chamber. Gazing upon the form of the Tathāgata and other deities endowed with every supreme quality, one turns toward the deity, makes prostration, and, following the rite, examines with cupped palms of flowers and with pure scented water to whatever extent one is able. Then, settled excellently in meditative absorption:

Bathing water, flowers, incense, and the rest are present.

With non-conceptual mind,
the offerings have been presented.
In meditative equipoise, with this mantra,
one recites three times:

Oṃ samaya stvaṃ samaya ho ahaṃ.

Just as all the buddhas
dwell in Tuṣita heaven,
like the goddess entering the womb in a magical display,
so too abide within this image here.

O Protector, remain here always.
For the sake of arousing the awakening mind
and for the sake of great purpose,
with whatever abundance is mine,
pray accept these offerings as they are —
these flowers and the rest.
Upon me and upon my disciples together
look with affection and care.

May all consecrate this,
and may it be fitting that you remain here in very truth.

Having well prepared the sacred image,
one then commences to abide in steadiness.
The disciple, keeping the fast,
having practiced all things accordingly,
whatever the mantra-holder has assigned —
the rites of offering and the rest,
as the master has directed —
all that is as yet incomplete one should complete.
The merit-offering shall become greatly fruitful.

Then the mantra-holder requests the gracious hearing.
Dissolved into the seat, one presents with mantra
the ritual water, the offering tormā (votive cake), incense, flowers,
and likewise the lamps.
One makes prostration before the sacred image,
wraps it in yellow cloth,
and then the mantra-holder must especially perform fumigation.

To accomplish those purposes, one casts it once into that,
and into fire, and then into water, with this mantra:

Oṃ sarva pāpaṃ dahana vajrāya svāhā.

Then one meditates on the supreme endowed with all aspects
in accordance with reality,

and thereafter dissolves into the three places —
the three syllables Oṃ, Hūṃ, and Āḥ:

Oṃ is dissolved at the crown of the head;
Hūṃ becomes the syllable at the heart;
and Āḥ is placed in the region of speech.
Body, speech, and mind one accomplishes.

Alternatively, whatever the seed-syllable of that deity may be,
one places it at that deity's heart.
Thoroughly invoking with mudrā and mantra,
one requests gracious hearing as is fitting.

As the vessel for the ritual water, one may use
gold, silver, or copper,
stone, wood, or earth,
a conch,
or equally the leaves of a tree.

Likewise a golden vessel for a water offering,
or a vessel of copper — these are most auspicious.
If one is unable to obtain them by capacity,
one does with whatever one has at hand.

Then with a brush of sesame oil and durva grass,
one cleanses thoroughly.
Young attendants proclaim in the same way
the sounds of auspicious drums and the rest.
The sesame oil and the rest one consecrates with mantra:

Oṃ sarva tathāgata kāya viśodhane svāhā.

Five or eight vases one anoints with sandalwood and the rest,
fills with water of varied fragrances,
arranges them in a circle, and praises them aloud.

The thread spun by a girl, or equally wool thread, will do.
One dyes it with the great dye-colors
and wraps it with mantra.

The five medicines and the five precious substances,
together with flowers and fruits,
adorned with flowers and mustard seed —

with these one consecrates the vase.

With the mantras of Uṣṇīṣavijayā,
of Splendor Not Consumed by Another,
and of Auspicious Peace,
one consecrates for the purpose of bathing.

Refined sesame oil and a fine twig of the udumbara fig —
arranged inside a vessel with a handle,
these one presents as offering.
One anoints them with the five fragrances,
and anoints them with the seed-syllable.

Together with the assembled disciples,
one washes them pure with mantra.
With joyful mind one recites verses that are auspicious and delightful.
According to the rite one confers the empowerment.

The mantra is:

Just as at the moment of birth
all the Tathāgatas were bathed —
— with pure divine water,
likewise do I bathe you.

Oṃ sarva-tathāgata-abhiṣekata-samaya-śriye hūṃ.

The actual images one washes in person; the painted representations one washes in a mirror. One first dedicates with the five verbal acts. One anoints with dūrvā grass. With cloth or with one's hands, the wise one wipes the body of the image. One anoints it with saffron mixed with butter. One also dresses it in a pair of garments. With this mantra, the wise one installs it at the center of the maṇḍala:

Oṃ vajra-dhīvase svāhā. Oṃ vajra-gandhe svāhā. Oṃ vajra-āvaraṇa-viśuddhe svāhā.

The wise one then rouses one's own samaya. One confers empowerment with mudrā and mantra, and bestows the crown empowerment as is fitting:

Oṃ hūṃ aṃ jṛīm khaṃ.

Having thus bound on the crown, one properly seats the image upon its throne, in the manner taught in the tantras. Facing forward, binding the

mother-and-child together — without crookedness and with straightness — one thus sets the image in beautiful form. If it is otherwise, faults will arise.

Flowers, incense, and likewise fragrance, lamps, food-offerings, and so on — all these, accompanied by mantra, one presents as offering to the deities:

Oṃ vajra-puṣpe āḥ hūṃ —

and so forth.

These supreme flowers — born likewise from water and from land — with the highest faith I offer them to you. Receive each as you please.

Born of the conjunction of co-arisen factors, this most excellent incense — with my faith I offer it. Please receive it as you please.

Born of the conjunction of co-arisen factors, this supreme fragrance — with my faith I offer it. Please receive it as you please.

This supreme illumination, dispeller of darkness, this lamp of butter and sesame oil — in order to enhance true primordial wisdom, with faith do I offer it.

Food and refreshment in full abundance, endowed with color and taste in all their richness — this divine food-offering complete in all, I offer; receive each separately.

And so on, and whatever else is at hand in however small a quantity for the image — all of these one presents in order, one by one.

One cleanses it with the mantra, making it pure and beautiful. There one opens the eyes with a golden implement. The wise one then presents food before it:

Oṃ cakṣuḥ-cakṣuḥ samanta-cakṣu-viśodhani svāhā. Oṃ
dhyāna-samādhi-prīṇane svāhā.

Having thus recited, one then admits the disciples and says:

The particular images you requested of me — I have performed their proper consecration as it has been taught, their purpose has been accomplished. Worship them now as you please.

Thereupon, having conferred the samaya empowerment upon you, one performs the fire offering: one thousand oblations, or half that number — with the seeds of grains mentioned before, on firewood of the milky-sap trees, one performs the fire offering in a square fire pit. With what remains of that same

butter and milk, one offers it as the final oblation, so that I and all disciples may increase in peace and in flourishing.

Oṃ vajra-āyuse svāhā. Āgaccha hari-piṅgale tejate tejahalo-hitakṣa dehi-dapaya idaṃ ca lyekāryaṃ kuru svāhā. Oṃ vajra-puṣṭāya svāhā.

Having done thus with diligence, one seats the image upon its throne. One carefully examines whether it corresponds to a third part of the measure of the image.

Oṃ su-pratiṣṭha-vajra svāhā.

The guardians of the directions are also to be worshipped with the preliminary offering of flowers, incense, and so on.

Oṃ indrāya svāhā —

and with this, making the sound of music continuously up to the lord of the gods, one worships properly. Then one performs the sending-forth:

Fully awakened buddhas and their sons,
and the assembled hosts of gods such as Brahmā and the rest —
whatever in this rite has been incomplete,
it is fitting that you bear with us and show forbearance.

May you, having greatly blessed the patron's life with peace and flourishing throughout, depart to the realm of the buddhas and please come again.

May all the gods of earth, water, fire, and wind guard this image for a hundred aeons. Having become pleased and well-disposed, may they protect the children and grandchildren of the master together with his disciples, and may they go happily to their own abode.

The first month of spring, the middle month of spring, the last months of winter and spring, the first month of summer, and likewise the middle of summer — these are when the sun gazes northward: that is the second fortnight of the bright half. In due order, the third, or whenever the day of the week is concordant, one may also begin in the dark fortnight. When all conditions are favorable, it causes long flourishing for people.

The fifteenth is auspicious, as is the eighth; the thirteenth is likewise auspicious. The new moon and the fourteenth are not appropriate. In all cases the asterisms Anurādhā, Mṛgaśīras, Hasta, Śravaṇā, Revatī, and Uttara are universally auspicious, as are Jyēṣṭhā, Anuradha, and Uttarāṣāḍhā — all these asterisms everywhere cause beings to flourish, and this makes the

consecration supremely excellent.

To perform the consecration under the asterism Rohiṇī produces great wisdom, and the four spiritual attainments grant whatever one wishes in one's mind. Correct knowledge born from the body: under Mṛgaśiras or Hasta, one gains victory over others through the fortune of the good hand and Bharaṇī. Under the head-asterisms, peace is brought near. Under the upper asterisms, children thrive. Under Revatī, spiritual attainment is perpetual. Under Śravaṇā, longevity is permanent. Under Punarvasu, one is made supremely happy. Under the divine junction, supreme excellence is bestowed.

Thursday, Wednesday, the clearing of Punarvasu, the moon, the planets and so forth — these are to be known. When these are performed with auspicious planets, the consecration becomes supremely meritorious.

On the third, sixth, seventh, tenth, and eleventh days, the moon is auspicious; on the second, fourth, and eighth, as well as the tenth and eleventh, Wednesday is auspicious; on the second, seventh, ninth, and likewise the eleventh, Thursday is auspicious. Relying on the peaceful conjunction of these times, one should perform the consecration with special care. The sixth, seventh, and tenth being excluded, the clearing of Punarvasu is itself auspicious. Thus the strength or weakness of all the planets is to be known accordingly.

When the planets are peaceful and the fields are auspicious, the first, fifth, and third are those; the wealth-destroying ones are to be avoided. The one who makes everything concordant accomplishes everything in that very moment, and when everything is performed just as taught, the consecration becomes supremely excellent. One will undoubtedly attain sovereignty, the power of a wheel-turning monarch. There, planets and asterisms become free of obstacles, and there are no misleading influences. All the planets become harmonious, and the very gods of the planets and asterisms dwell there, all established in that place, bestowing the attainments of images, stūpas, and the like. Whatever is contemplated even briefly in the mind will be accomplished birth after birth.

With all the ornaments complete, one thereafter makes offerings to the craftsmen on the outside. Those who have assisted in the work should also be honored. Then, with joy, one addresses all of them with these words: "I have no capacity to perform all the offerings as they have been taught; therefore, please bear with me." The ritual purity food of the mantra, together with the

food offerings, is to be given to the images. These Sugata remnants will quickly purify evil.

Thus it is said. The excellent fee for the patron is to be given: elephants, horses, oxen, carriages, and wealth. And then, with great care, one is to give movable possessions as the offering of enjoyment.

If the god himself wishes to be pleased,
one should please the guru with reverence,
and in all ways without exception
one should truly satisfy the guru.

Then those who possess authentic observance — monks (bhikṣus), laymen, and nuns — are to be honored with the utmost respect and given offerings fitting to each.

With the sound of conch shells and musical instruments,
with noble songs and dances,
and with the great music of relatives, kinfolk, and attendants,
one offers a great celebration through the night.

When all of this has been done, whatever offerings and oblations have been made or are to be made to the maṇḍala are to be presented to the master.

They are not to be given to craftsmen,
nor are they to be given to the monks.

The master is the supreme deity,
and all wealth is to be offered to him.

Then the maṇḍala is to be smeared —
smeared with a thick paste of cow dung —
and the colored sand is to be cast into a river.

Finally, it is to be anointed well and completely with fragrant substances.

Here ends the tantra of the abbreviated rite of consecration.

This was translated by the great Kashmiri paṇḍita Jñānavajra and the translator, the monk Dro Sherab Drakpa.

Translator's Notes

- The phrase rendered "results in rebirth among those who will see or be seen" translates □□□□□□□□□□□□□□□□□□□□, literally "is born among those who see and those who do not"

see." The precise doctrinal referent is somewhat ambiguous; it may indicate fortunate rebirths in places where one encounters sacred images, or may refer to two categories of beings distinguished by whether they can or cannot perceive subtle phenomena. This is noted as a genuinely open question in interpretation.

The phrase 他物を通じての奉獻, rendered "it is through the other that consecration is performed," is compressed and slightly elliptical. "The other" likely refers to the conventional level of reality, as clarified by the following verse about the two truths.

- The phrase rendered "Splendor Not Consumed by Another" translates the mantra name ॐ नमो भगवते वासुदेवाय, which corresponds to the Sanskrit dhāraṇī known as Tejorāśī or a related text in the usnīsa-dhāraṇī corpus; the exact Sanskrit title is not given in the passage.

The mantra fragment at the close is the opening of the standard bathing verse found in abhiṣeka rites across many Tibetan traditions; the passage breaks mid-verse, consistent with its role as a continuation prompt.

- The phrase rendered "binding the mother-and-child together" refers to a technical iconographic procedure of securing the main image with its associated subsidiary figure; the precise mechanical meaning may vary by tradition and the term is left as a descriptive rendering.

The mantra "Āgaccha hari-piṅgale tejate..." is a dhāraṇī invocation whose individual terms resist clean segmentation into standard Sanskrit; it is transliterated as it stands without forced parsing.

"A third part of the measure of the image" renders a somewhat compressed iconometric phrase; it likely refers to a proportional check stipulated in the relevant tantra, the exact rule of which would be clarified by the root text referenced.

- The passage is a highly technical ritual calendar section specifying auspicious asterisms (Sanskrit nakṣatras) for the consecration rite. The Tibetan terms for the asterisms are partially phonetic renderings and partially descriptive epithets. Identification of individual asterisms follows the standard Indo-Tibetan nakṣatra system: Anurādhā, Mrgaśiras, Hasta, Śravaṇā, Revatī, Uttara, Rohiṇī, Bharaṇī, Punarvasu, Jyeṣṭhā, and Uttarāṣāḍhā are the most plausible identifications, though several correspondences between the Tibetan descriptive names and the Sanskrit nakṣatra list are genuinely uncertain and scholars differ on a few of them. The term rendered "divine junction" for རྒྱལ་འབྲེལ་ཡུལ་ is uncertain; it may refer to the nakṣatra Abhijit or to a juncture of auspicious planetary positions.

The opening verses, continuing from the preceding passage, are a prayer of sending-forth (Skt. visarjana) addressed to the invited deities. The phrase རྒྱལ་གྲོང་དུ་སྐྱོད་པར་བློན་པའི།
("having departed to the realm of the buddhas") refers to the invited wisdom-beings returning to their natural abode after the ritual, a standard element of the visarjana.

- The colophon names the text's translators: the paṇḍita Jñānavajra from Kashmir and the Tibetan lotsāwa Dro Sherab Drakpa. The term rendered "authentic observance" is the Tibetan for those who hold genuine ethical discipline or vows, grouping the three categories of ordained and lay practitioners that follow. The instruction that all maṇḍala offerings go exclusively to the ācārya (master), and not to craftsmen or even to monks, reflects a standard Vajrayāna principle that the ritual master is identified with the principal deity of the maṇḍala and is therefore the proper recipient of all offerings made within it.

Colophon

This is an AI-generated translation from the AI Stupa project. It was produced by a careful, doctrine-aware process aiming at a high degree of accuracy, but it has not been reviewed by a human translator and may contain errors. It is offered as a provisional translation for those texts of the Tibetan Buddhist canon that have not yet received an authoritative human translation. Where a published translation exists — above all from 84000: Translating the Words of the Buddha (84000.co) — that translation is definitive and should be preferred; please consult it instead. These translations are released into the public domain (CC0) in the spirit of spreading the Dharma to all corners of the earth.

Just as the Bodhi tree now standing at Bodh Gayā neither is nor is not the same tree beneath which the Buddha attained awakening, so too this stupa is intended as the next generation of stupa — dependently arising according to the conditions of its environment, and ceaselessly proclaiming the Dharma for the benefit of all sentient beings.

May whoever encounters these words derive great benefit.